SkillNavora

MODULE 7 HANDBOOK

Module 7: Email Studio

5 sections, 41 topics explained, plus the detailed lessons, examples, exercises and official links.

Salesforce Marketing Cloud (SFMC) Academy. Verify product names, editions, licences and certifications on Salesforce's official pages.

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Edition: November 2026. Practice labs marked "account" need a provisioned Marketing Cloud account. Other labs use sample files or paper.

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Module 7: Email Studio

Level: Beginner to intermediate. Email Studio: sends, subscriber status, suppression and deliverability.

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Detailed lessons

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7.1 Sends, classifications and subscriber status

WHAT IS IT?

> An email send is a definition with a data source, a send classification (commercial or transactional, depending on the law and consent), a sender profile and a delivery profile. Subscriber status includes active, unsubscribed, bounced and held.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Sending commercial email to unsubscribed people breaks the law in many places and damages reputation.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Create the email, then the send definition.
2. Choose the send classification that matches the message (commercial needs consent and an unsubscribe link).
3. Use suppression lists for people who must not receive the message.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A password reset is transactional; a promotion is commercial with unsubscribe.

COMMON ERRORS

Using a commercial classification for transactional mail, or the reverse.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What is a send classification?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Classify five sample messages and explain each choice.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Salesforce Help: Marketing Cloud Engagement

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7.2 Deliverability: SPF, DKIM, DMARC and bounce management

WHAT IS IT?

> SPF lists the servers allowed to send for a domain; DKIM signs messages; DMARC tells receivers what to do when checks fail. Bounces are hard (invalid address) or soft (temporary). Complaints and bounce rates affect reputation.

WHY IS IT IMPORTANT?

> Good deliverability decides whether the message is seen at all.

HOW DOES IT WORK AND THE STEPS

1. Publish SPF and DKIM for the sending domain.
2. Add a DMARC policy starting with monitoring (p=none).
3. Remove hard-bounced addresses from the send.
4. Watch complaint rates after each send.

REAL-WORLD EXAMPLE

> A hard bounce is suppressed automatically; a soft bounce is retried by the system.

COMMON ERRORS

Sending to old lists without removing bounces.

INTERVIEW QUESTION

What does DMARC do?

HANDS-ON EXERCISE

Write a deliverability checklist for a new sending domain.

OFFICIAL DOCUMENTATION AND FURTHER READING

- Google: email sender guidelines

7.1 Email Studio Fundamentals: every topic explained

Email Studio interface. The studio for creating, sending and tracking email.

Email campaign lifecycle. Plan, build, test, send, measure, improve.

Email creation. Build in Content Builder with templates and blocks.

Email templates. Reusable layouts with editable regions.

Email assets. Images, blocks and documents used in emails.

Email classifications. Commercial or transactional classification attached to sends.

7.2 Email Sending: every topic explained

Send definitions. Saved settings for a send: email, audience, classification and options.

User-initiated sends. Sends started by a user (manual or scheduled).

Triggered sends. Sends started by an API call or event, such as a receipt.

Test sends. Sends to test audiences before the real send.

Guided sends where applicable. Step-by-step send flow in the interface where available.

Send scheduling. Setting a future send time.

Audience selection. Choosing lists or data extensions and exclusions.

Send classifications. The legal and delivery settings applied to the send.

7.3 Subscriber Management: every topic explained

Subscriber status. Active, unsubscribed, held or bounced, per subscriber.

Active subscribers. Subscribers who can receive email.

Unsubscribed subscribers. Opted out; they must not receive commercial email.

Bounced subscribers. Addresses that bounced; repeated hard bounces lead to held status.

Held subscribers. Addresses held after too many bounces; they are not sent to.

Suppression lists. Lists of addresses never to be sent to.

Publication lists. Lists that track opt-in by topic or purpose.

Global unsubscribes. Opt-outs that apply across the account.

7.4 Email Deliverability: every topic explained

SPF. A DNS record listing servers allowed to send for a domain.

DKIM. A signature that proves the message was not changed and came from the domain.

DMARC. A policy telling receivers how to handle mail that fails SPF or DKIM, with reports.

Sender authentication. The SFMC setup that applies SPF, DKIM and branded domains to sends.

IP reputation. The reputation of the sending IP address with mailbox providers.

Domain reputation. The reputation of the sending domain.

Dedicated versus shared IP. Dedicated IPs carry only your reputation; shared IPs are shared with other senders.

Email throttling. Spreading a large send over time to protect reputation.

Bounce management. Processing hard and soft bounces and removing bad addresses.

Spam complaints. Complaints from recipients marking mail as spam; keep them very low.

Inbox placement. Whether mail lands in the inbox, promotions or spam folder.

7.5 Advanced Email Campaigns: every topic explained

Dynamic content. Content that changes by subscriber data or rules.

Personalised email. Email that uses the subscriber's data, such as name and recent products.

A/B testing. Testing two versions (subject, content) on part of the audience, then sending the winner.

Send-time optimisation. Sending at the time each subscriber is most likely to engage, where the feature is licensed.

Segmented campaigns. Different messages for different segments.

Triggered email. Email sent automatically on an event.

Transactional messaging. Receipts and account notices, sent with a transactional classification.

Campaign reporting. Tracking and reports on send performance.